



115 Too Dumb For A Smartphone?



120 Talk To The Dead



136 Preference For Pink

Digital Leisure

Technology Beyond Work

Touched By Tech

And Then, There Was Light

Computer education at Mumbai's Helen Keller Institute for Deaf and Deafblind helps students become economically independent and helps them communicate effectively

"A person who is severely handicapped never knows his own hidden source of strength until he is treated like a normal human being and allowed and supported to shape his own life—for life is either a challenge and an adventure or nothing at all."

- Dr Helen Keller

Renuka Rane

They gently feel your hands, your watch, the shape of your fingernails and the texture of your skin. Their hands talk and are, in effect, their eyes. They write the letters of the alpha-

bet on your palm and tap your wrist to signal the end of each word. After this novel exercise in palm printing follows an interactive session on the computer.

"Hi Zamir."

"Hello."

"How are you?"

"I am doing fine."

"Tell me more about yourself."

"I first came to the Helen Keller Institute for the Deaf and Deafblind when I was 12..."

Does this resemble a chat transcript? Actually, it is a written dialogue in MS Word, with Zamir Dhale, who is deaf-blind. Dhale cannot use the mouse, can't see the monitor and neither can he



Photographs: Jiten Gandhi
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